the waiting arms of the KGB, the Soviet intelligence organisation. The CIA admits that Ames may have compromised at least a hundred operations and may have endangered the lives of dozens of Soviets working for the American agency. In 1986 when CIA agents started disappearing, a hunt was launched to find the leak within the American intelligence apparatus. The CIA counterintelligence team led by well-known spy hunter Jeanne Vertefeuille discussed three possibilities for the failed and compromised operations: One, the KGB had infiltrated the agency's communications and read the traffic. Two, the KGB in Moscow had obtained access to CIA documents regarding the compromised cases or placed a bug or three, there was a mole within the agency.

As with the Rabinder Singh case, the CIA spy hunter team's biggest challenge was to establish that there was a mole within the agency and once they did this in 1989, as they brought Ames under the scanner, they were required to collect solid proof that his lavish lifestyle had been earned by selling secrets and betraying his comrades in arms. After years of patience and carefully analysing Ames's ill-gotten wealth, the CIA spy hunters came to believe that there was a link between his meetings with Soviet diplomats and the huge deposits in his bank accounts. He was arrested by the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) just as he prepared for a trip to Moscow, a journey the investigators believed was one way. CIA officials said that during his career as a mole, Ames had received $2.5 million from the KGB and another $2.1 million had been earmarked for him at a bank in Moscow.

How much did Rabinder Singh receive from the CIA? There are only speculations, no concrete figures. How much damage did